

What's new in Fynla — 29 and 30 September 2026

These two days fill in the "how to" guides for savings and protection, rebuild the protection cards so they say plainly how much cover you are short, and fix a long list of things found when real people used the Save Tax journey on their phones: the questionnaire now promises only what your plan delivers, and your plan no longer counts the same saving twice. Your partner's details are now used rather than asked for again: what you give for them is waiting for them to confirm, and a retired partner's pension arrives as pension income. Fyn answers "Ask Fyn about this" from the card you asked about, never tells you how sure it is, says so when a reply is cut off, and answers a question you type during setup instead of taking it as a tick. Your date of birth no longer moves back a day when you save it, and both servers now hold only what the site needs to run.

This is live on fynla.org through eight releases:

- **29 September, about 10:41:** release #966 (savings guides and Fyn), with a fix at about 10:51 (#968).
- **29 September, about 14:46:** release #994 (protection), with its last three guides at about 14:55 (#996).
- **29 September, about 20:25:** release #1008 (Save Tax, your partner's details, setup and Fyn fixes).
- **30 September, about 08:18:** release #1012 (date of birth, questions during setup, servers).
- **30 September, about 10:44:** release #1015 (your partner confirms what you gave for them; a retired partner's pension income; Marriage Allowance).
- **30 September, about 11:46:** release #1017 (#1016: a retired partner's income is counted once).

Releases #966, #994, #1012, #1015 and #1017 were walked on the test site first. The 29 September evening release (#1008) was walked on local copies of the app before merging, not on the test site. Every release was then checked on fynla.org itself (see "What we checked").

Savings actions explain how to do them

- **Every savings action now has approved "how to" steps:** 26 guides covering 41 actions, each checked and approved before release. The steps use the figures on your own card.
- **A £0 Personal Savings Allowance is no longer called "nearly used"** when you earn no interest.
- **Rates you are compared against name their source:** the provider and date from MoneySavingExpert.
- **A child's Junior ISA is no longer read as your Cash ISA.** On the live site, a family's steps said "your Cash ISA with Vanguard" when it was the child's Junior ISA. Fixed the same morning.
- **"Consider a Cash ISA" is no longer shown to someone who already has one.** A Cash ISA added by telling Fyn was not recognised, and was also missing from the ISA allowance total. Junior and Lifetime ISAs are still not counted as a Cash ISA.
- **"Coordinate ISA Usage with Your Partner" no longer says an allowance is full when it is not.** Both partners' ISA allowances are read from the same record the Savings page shows.
- **The actions list no longer shows internal labels** such as "Lifecycle" or "Warning" as a topic.

Protection shows the cover you are short of

- **One card per type of cover:** life insurance, critical illness and income protection. Each card says how much cover you have, how much you need and the gap. The separate "gap" and "reliance" cards are folded into these as reasons.
- **A new "Your cover" section on the Protection page,** on the desktop and mobile web apps, shows the same three figures.
- **The need is worked out properly.** It no longer uses a fixed three times income or 70% of take-home pay, and your life cover gap no longer subtracts critical illness cover, which pays out on diagnosis, not death.
- **You can record your employer's benefits** (death in service, income protection, critical illness cover or private medical insurance) on the Protection page, on mobile, or by telling Fyn. "None" now counts as an answer, so you are not asked again.
- **Statutory Sick Pay is worked out for each person** from the tax settings: the weekly rate or 80% of normal weekly earnings, whichever is lower, with no lower earnings limit from the 2026/27 tax year ([gov.uk: Statutory Sick Pay](https://gov.uk/statutory-sick-pay)).
- **29 protection guides are approved and live,** including the three for the new cover cards.
- **The desktop Protection page now shows the same gaps as the mobile app.** It used to work them out in the browser with its own figures.

Save Tax promises what your plan delivers

- **The questionnaire's estimate now matches the plan you get.** In testing on fynla.org, someone earning £110,000 with a partner who does not earn was promised £22,562 and given a plan worth about £5,550. The estimate now uses the same sums as your plan, and a check stops the two drifting apart.
- **The estimate says which income it assumes** (the top of the band you chose, or an example income for the top band) and no longer calls itself an average. It mentions your partner only when part of the figure is theirs, and says "Available to your partner" on their lines. For the top band, it says the pension figure fills your whole Annual Allowance.
- **No more savings from "moving income" to your partner.** Salary is taxed on the person who earns it (Income Tax (Earnings and Pensions) Act 2003 s62), so those lines are removed.
- **Marriage Allowance is worked out whichever of you earns less,** and never counts for more than the tax the receiving partner pays.
- **"No income" is now an answer in the questionnaire.** Someone with no income is greeted properly, and their pension suggestion is capped at what they have in savings, because that is where the payment would come from. The allowance row reads "Pension contribution limit without earnings".
- **Someone who is retired or not working is offered a personal pension:** "pay £2,880 into a personal pension and HM Revenue & Customs (HMRC) adds £720", up to the £3,600 a year a non-earner can pay in with tax relief (Finance Act 2004 s190; [gov.uk: pension tax relief](https://gov.uk/pension-tax-relief)). The questionnaire and the plan say the same.
- **A partner in the 60% band is priced by whether they earn.** When your partner earns £100,001 to £125,140, a new question asks about their work. A partner living on a pension or rent can get relief on at most £3,600 gross (Finance Act 2004 s190), so they are no longer promised the saving a working partner would get.

- **The partner card in the 60% band reads "reclaims all but £20 of their Personal Allowance"** when a whole-pound contribution cannot reclaim all of it (Income Tax Act 2007 s35).
- **Scottish taxpayers are told the estimate uses England, Wales and Northern Ireland Income Tax rates**, as the plan does. A Marriage Allowance recipient whose income is above the Scottish intermediate rate limit is warned that it does not apply to them (Income Tax Act 2007 s55B(2)(b); [gov.uk: Scottish Income Tax](https://gov.uk/scottish-income-tax); [gov.uk: Marriage Allowance eligibility](https://gov.uk/marriage-allowance-eligibility)). The limit comes from the tax settings.
- **The Save Tax question counter always reads "of 4"**, including after you say you have a partner and when the partner-work question appears. It used to jump from "3 of 4" to "4 of 5".
- **Invented reviews and member counts are removed** from the Pension Check and Save Tax plan pages.
- **A hand-edited Save Tax plan link no longer shows an error page.**

Your tax plan no longer counts a saving twice

- **Your pension contribution is priced first**, on your income today. The savings choices are then priced on what is left once the pension is paid, and their "how to" steps say so, for example "Once your £6,700 pension contribution is paid, ...".
- **Choices that do the same job are labelled.** Putting savings into an ISA, giving savings to your partner and splitting savings 50/50 in a joint account each remove the same taxable interest, so only one can count. The ones not counted read "Not counted in your total." and their saving is shown in grey, on the Tax Strategy page on the desktop and mobile web apps and on the action cards.
- **The same interest is no longer counted twice.** For one household earning £110,000, the headline read £6,000 when doing everything actually saved £5,560. The headline is now £5,560.
- **The ISA card gives the right interest figure.** It says how much of your interest is above your Personal Savings Allowance and, separately, how much a year's ISA allowance would shelter. Before, it gave the sheltered figure as the amount above the allowance, and Fyn repeated it.
- **Self-employed people are told how their pension relief actually reaches them:** added by the provider, with any higher-rate relief claimed through Self Assessment, not "through your pay" ([gov.uk: pension tax relief](https://gov.uk/pension-tax-relief)).
- **Figures in the plan's sentences are whole pounds**, "£675", not "£675.00".

Your partner's details are used, not asked twice

- **Your partner's own setup opens each account you gave for them, to confirm.** When you invite your partner and have already entered their savings, ISA, investments or pension, their setup opens that account with your figures filled in. They check it and save. Before, the form opened blank and saving added a second copy beside yours. "Add another" still opens a blank form, for anything you did not know about.
- **Your partner's own job replaces the income you entered for them.** Before, the two were added together (one live account showed £64,000 instead of £32,000; it was repaired the same evening). Their income form opens with your figure filled in, and saving it updates that one job.
- **Your partner is not asked what your linked account already says:** your earnings band, whether you work, or your income typed in by hand.

- **Your partner's earnings are carried across as pay.** If they are retired, the rest arrives as pension income, drawn from their pension: their Income page reads "Pension income", and it is taxed as pension income, with no National Insurance. For a partner who is not retired, income other than pay stays "other income", because it could be rent as much as a pension. If we do not know whether they work, the income you gave arrives as an estimate of their pay, which their own job replaces. When they then say they are retired, it becomes what they draw from their pension; when they say they are not working, it becomes other income.
- **Your retired partner now sees their pension during setup,** filled in with what they draw, to confirm. Before, the step was skipped.
- **A retired partner's income is counted once.** When you gave your partner's income without saying they are retired, and they then answered "Retired" and confirmed what they draw, the same money was counted as both pay and pension. On fynla.org one partner showed £60,000 instead of £30,000, taxed at the higher rate with National Insurance, and was told to pay £9,700 into a pension. Their Income page now reads "Pension income £30,000", with no National Insurance.
- **"Your spouse's allowances" on the Tax Strategy page uses your linked partner's own records,** the same figures their own page shows, instead of "Current-year use not confirmed".
- **Marriage Allowance is offered only when it applies.** It uses the income you gave for your partner when their own account does not hold any yet. A couple earning £32,000 and £72,000 was being offered £252 a year it could not claim, because the higher earner's own account was still empty. Marriage Allowance needs one partner to earn less than their Personal Allowance and the other to pay tax at the basic rate ([gov.uk: Marriage Allowance](https://gov.uk/marriage-allowance)). If your partner's account holds income, that figure is used; if neither of you has given it, the action waits until you do.
- **The invitation email greets your partner by their first name,** not "Hello,".
- **An invitation opened on the same phone after signing out of the mobile app now shows the registration form,** not "Sign in".

Editing an account keeps what you entered

- **Editing an investment account keeps the dividends it pays.** Before, an edit dropped them, even though Fyn replied that it had updated them. The yearly dividend total used for tax now moves by the change.
- **Editing a personal pension keeps what you draw from it each year and any tax-free lump sum already taken.** Before, both were lost on an edit.
- **Workplace pensions and General Investment Accounts (GIAs) open as the right kind when you edit them.** Every workplace pension opened as a personal pension, and every GIA as "other".

Setting up with Fyn

- **A question you type during setup gets an answer.** Typing "What is the ISA allowance this year?" at "Which of these do you have?" ticked ISA, and the question was never answered. Fyn now answers it ("The ISA allowance for the 2026/27 tax year is £20,000 per person"; [gov.uk: ISAs](https://gov.uk/isas)), asks the same question again, and records nothing until you tap. The same applies to every setup question with buttons: "Does my partner count if we are not married?" used to be recorded as "No", because "not" contains "no".

- **At "Which of these do you have?", you tap each account, then one button sends them all.** Before, tapping several quickly kept only the first, and the steps for the others were skipped.
- **Fyn always greets you and reads back what you told the questionnaire,** even when you said you are not working and the income question is skipped. It greets you once, not again when you come back.
- **If the income you enter is very different from the band you chose,** Fyn checks with you ("Earlier you told us you have no income, but you've entered £40,000..."). This check had stopped running on the desktop and mobile web apps. £0 against "No income" is not queried.
- **When some of your plan's savings are alternatives,** Fyn's setup summary says they are a choice and which one your total counts.

Fyn

- **"Ask Fyn about this" is answered from the card itself,** with the card's own figures.
- **Fyn never states how certain it is.** A filter removes any sentence claiming certainty from Fyn's replies, as they stream and as they are stored.
- **Fyn tells you when savings choices are alternatives.** Asked whether an ISA, a gift to your partner and a 50/50 split add up, Fyn is now given the fact that they are one choice, and which one your plan total counts, wherever it reads your plan.
- **If a reply is cut off, Fyn says so and offers "Try again".** Before, a reply could stop part-way with no answer and no message. Trying again never takes the same turn twice.
- **On mobile, the conversation is kept while you are signed in,** and the dashboard no longer reopens Fyn by itself.
- **The desktop Fyn panel starts collapsed on every visit.**

Your date of birth and personal details

- **Saving Personal Info no longer moves your date of birth back a day.** On the desktop web app, every save of a summer birthday stored the day before: 1 May became 30 April, then 29 April. The date is now stored exactly as you enter it.
- **Dates read the same wherever you are.** Someone outside UK time could see, and save back, the day before. Dates of birth now show the same calendar day in every time zone.
- **The mobile app shows your date of birth in words,** "1 May 1985", as the desktop does. It used to show 1985-05-01.
- **Employment status shows "Full-Time",** not the internal code.
- **People born in England, Scotland, Wales or Northern Ireland can save Personal Info again.**
- **A refused save keeps your form,** and residence for Inheritance Tax is described in plain words.

Mobile app fixes

- **The dashboard Investment card shows your accounts** before you have given your spending. It read "0 accounts, £0" for someone who had them.

- **The Investments page explains the ISA count:** "Includes your Cash ISA, which is listed under Bank Accounts."
- **A jointly owned property shows your share** and the full value, as the investment and bank lists already did.
- **A dashboard card with actions says how many**, "3 actions", instead of "Warning" or a blank line.
- **Form fields show a violet outline when you are typing in them.**
- **Choice questions in Fyn's forms are labelled properly for screen readers**, on the desktop too.
- **/m/savetax opens the campaign inside the mobile app** instead of a missing page. So do the other campaign pages and the registration and sign-in addresses under /m.
- **Signing out of the mobile app also signs out the desktop app shown inside it.**
- **The screen behind Fyn refreshes after Fyn saves a record.**

The servers hold only what the site needs

- **Both servers are cleaned.** The test server held the whole project: planning notes, handovers, documentation, tests, the iPhone app's source and tooling folders. fynla.org held leftovers from early uploads. Both now hold only the files the site runs on. The test server went from 3.3 GB to 960 MB, fynla.org from 690 MB to 633 MB.
- **Design mockups are no longer public.** fynla.org was serving old design mockup pages to anyone who knew the address. They are gone from the site and kept with the design documents.
- **One list decides what a server may hold**, and every entry says which part of the app reads it. The test server now checks out only those files, so they cannot come back.

Decisions taken

- **Fyn never states certainty.** This is enforced on the output, not only in Fyn's instructions.
- **The pension contribution is priced first** (CSJ, 29 September), and the savings alternatives are labelled, with all three kept. The sheltered-interest pricing this made pointless is removed.
- **The £720 relief for a non-earner is counted and worded**, and a no-income arrival's pension is capped at their savings (CSJ, 29 September).
- **A partner in the 60% band is asked about their work**, and a non-earner is capped, as for the user (CSJ, 29 September).
- **Save Tax matches the plan on Scotland:** it uses the rest-of-UK rates and says so, and warns a Scottish Marriage Allowance recipient (CSJ, 29 September). Modelling Scottish Income Tax across the app would be a separate project.
- **Invented reviews and figures are removed, not replaced** (CSJ, 29 September). Fake consumer reviews are banned under the Digital Markets, Competition and Consumers Act 2024, Schedule 20.
- **What you give for your partner is transferred and stored where their own form would store it** (ruling 50, restated 29 September), so their setup confirms it rather than asking again.
- **If we do not know whether your partner works, the income you gave is carried across as an estimate of their pay** (CSJ, 29 September), which their own job replaces; if they say they are retired or not working, it is restated as pension or other income (30 September).

- **A retired partner's income other than pay is pension income;** for anyone else it stays other income (CSJ, 30 September).
- **Your partner's own account wins only when it holds income;** otherwise the income you gave is used.
- **A question typed at a setup step is answered and never taken as a choice;** only tapping the button (or its exact label) counts.
- **The fix for dates is at the source,** in how the date is stored, so every screen gets it.
- **Servers hold runtime files only** (CSJ, 30 September).

Still to do

- **Dates of birth that already slipped:** one account shows the pattern in the audit log and can be put back once agreed. Dates entered for the first time on the desktop cannot be traced.
- **The Retirement page for someone already retired** still shows years to go and a projected income, as if they were saving. It needs a view for people drawing from their pension.
- **Retirement, investment and estate "how to" guides.**

Behind the scenes

- **Much of the 29 September evening release came from our external contributor (ice-cube),** each change reviewed before merging: #961, #963, #970, #971, #973, #975, #976, #977, #978, #979, #980, #982, #983, #984, #986, #989, #990, #991, #993 and #1004. #971, #973, #975, #984, #986, #989, #991 and #993 were merged together through #1003, and #976, #979 and #980 through #1005, with conflicts resolved and review fixes on top. (#993 has no merge of its own; it arrived through #1003.)
- **Test reports (#970):** the 14 and 29 September production test runs, and a check of the Save Tax estimate against the plan for nine households. These found most of the Save Tax and partner fixes above.
- **Legal references corrected (#982):** code comments now cite the Marriage Allowance rules to the subsections that say them (Income Tax Act 2007 s55B(4)(b), s55B(5), s55C(1)(c)). No behaviour change. It notes that the app uses the gov.uk test for the lower earner, which is narrower than the law in a few savings-income cases; widening it is a tax-rule decision left open.
- **Pension Check reads its income bands from the tax settings (#986, #1003),** in the questionnaire and in Fyn's read-back, so a threshold change moves them. Save Tax's ISA assumption (10% of income) is now a named setting.
- **Protection cards come from one reviewed list of actions (#972),** as tax and savings do. The old seven-rule engine no longer feeds the cards. Protection cover is one calculation (#992), read by the plan, the cards and both apps.
- **Every Fyn reply now ends with a clear signal (#976),** so the app can tell a finished reply from a cut-off one. A tool that fails no longer stops the reply silently; Fyn answers around it.
- **Try again uses the same safeguard the iPhone app already had (#1005)** (an idempotency key), so a repeated request is recognised.

- **What Fyn says about alternatives has one source (#977, #1004)**, used by the card, the plan, Fyn's financial picture and the setup summary.
- **Fyn's greeting once (#1006)**: a fix made while merging put the greeting in front of every later setup form. It was caught in testing and fixed before the release.
- **A second check in setup (#1011)**: a message that looks like a question is sent to Fyn to answer unless it is exactly one of the buttons.
- **The desktop app checks a stored sign-in is still valid (#961)** before sending you away from the registration or sign-in pages.
- **The date is stored as a plain date (#1009)** (year, month, day), and the desktop no longer converts it through a timestamp before sending it.
- **deploy/server-runtime-paths.txt (#1010)** is the keep-list. Every release upload must fall inside it.
- **Specifications (#985, #988)** for the protection cover position; **iPhone app test fix (#962)**, so its automated tests never type without an on-screen keyboard.
- **At release, 29 September**: one database change (whether an employee's income is an estimate given by someone else), the protection and how-to lists reloaded, and a repair of the one spouse income that had been added twice.
- **At release, 30 September morning**: app code and both web bundles only; no database changes.
- **At release, 30 September second release**: server code only. No database, web app or mobile app bundle changes, so the desktop web app, the mobile web app and the iPhone app all get it at once. No partner transfers had happened on fynla.org since the partner income change arrived, so no existing accounts needed repair.

What we checked

- **Live on fynla.org, 29 September morning release**, as the Carter demo household on the desktop web app: the emergency fund card; "Consider a Cash ISA" with the ISA-left, spouse and children steps, and no Junior ISA read as the parent's; the actions list with no internal labels.
- **Live on fynla.org, protection release**, as the Carter household: "Your cover" showed life cover £131,953 short, critical illness £225,000 short and income protection £3,750 a month short, and the cards matched the page.
- **Live on fynla.org, mobile, with a new account**: life cover £872,551 short, then £632,551 after four times salary death-in-service was saved through Fyn; critical illness £180,000 short; income protection £3,000 a month short. The account was deleted afterwards.
- **Live on fynla.org, 29 September evening release**, on the desktop (full-size window) and mobile web apps with a new account: no invented reviews on the plan pages; "Your cover" agreeing with the coverage gaps; Fyn opening on sign-up, staying open between pages, and starting collapsed on a new visit; the partner-work screen showing "3 of 4"; Personal Info saving with England and Scotland as country of birth; "Try again" replacing a cut-off reply.
- **Live on fynla.org, 30 September morning release, with a new account, desktop web app (full-size window)**:
- At "Do you have a spouse or civil partner?", typing "Does my partner count if we are not married?" was answered, and the question was asked again with nothing recorded.

- At "Which of these do you have?", typing "What is the ISA allowance this year?" was answered with £20,000, and the question was asked again with nothing ticked.
- Personal Info: 1 May 1985 entered for the first time, then saved again unchanged. It stayed 1 May 1985, and read so after reloading the page.
- **Live on fynla.org, mobile web app, same account:** the ISA question was answered and the step asked again with nothing ticked; Personal Information read "1 May 1985". The account was deleted afterwards.
- **Live on fynla.org:** the mockup pages no longer load, and the site, mobile app, Pension Check and Save Tax plan pages all load.
- **Second 30 September release (#1015), live on fynla.org, desktop web app (full-size window):** a new account set up with a partner's £30,000 income and £200,000 Legal & General pension, then invited them. The partner registered from the invitation: their name and email were filled in, their pension step opened the Legal & General pension at £200,000 to confirm, and the partner questions were answered from the linked account. The walk found the partner's income counted twice (above), fixed in #1016.
- **Third 30 September release (#1017), live on fynla.org:** a partner given £30,000 and a £200,000 Legal & General pension with no status registered from the invitation and answered "Retired". Desktop web app (full-size window): their pension step opened with "You draw from it each year £30,000" filled in, and their Income page read "Pension Income £30,000", total £30,000, £3,486 Income Tax and "No National Insurance". Mobile web app: Income read "Your total annual income £30,000" and "Pension income £30,000". The accounts were deleted afterwards.
- **On the test site first:** the 29 September daytime changes, each on its own branch on the desktop and mobile web apps before it was merged; for the 30 September morning release, two saves of 1 May 1985 and of 15 July 1990 held the date, the 60% band card wording, the question at both kinds of setup step, and a real tap still recording the account; for #1015, desktop web app (full-size window) and mobile web app, two couples, each partner's setup opening the transferred savings, ISA, investment and pension accounts to confirm, with one of each at the end, dividends and drawdown kept on edit, a retired partner's Income page reading "Pension income £30,000", and Marriage Allowance no longer offered to the £32,000 / £72,000 couple; for #1016, desktop web app (full-size window) and mobile web app, a partner given £30,000 with no status answered "Retired": their pension step opened with £30,000 drawn filled in, and their Income page read "Pension income £30,000", total £30,000, "No National Insurance", on both.
- **On local copies of the app, not the test site:** the 29 September evening changes, including every change from our external contributor, were walked on the desktop and mobile web apps before merging.
- **Not tested on fynla.org:** the "HMRC adds £720" wording for a partner who does not earn (checked on a local copy before merging).

Not tested: the iPhone app

The server-side changes reach the iPhone app too, including the partner fixes, the questions during setup and Marriage Allowance. The iPhone app's own code for "Try again" and for tapping several accounts then sending them once was changed, but it has not been built or tested here, and it reaches iPhone users only with the next iPhone app release. None of these changes was tested on the iPhone app.